MÉXICO–INDIA
BUSINESS COUNCIL

The state map

India is 28 state markets, each its own licence, label and price file. Start narrow: one or two states.

01 START HERE

Maharashtra (Mumbai): the premium capital and your gateway port. Deep on-trade, organised retail, and the address most importers work from.

Delhi NCR: the deepest imported-spirits culture in the country; policy swings to watch, but the consumer is unmatched.

Karnataka (Bengaluru): the cocktail scene that sets national taste; bartender advocacy here travels.

Goa: friendly duties, tourism, the category's test kitchen. Small volumes, outsized visibility.

Haryana (Gurugram) and Telangana (Hyderabad): affluent, retail-friendly, fast-premiumising; strong second doors after Mumbai or Delhi.

02 LATER

Punjab and Chandigarh, Rajasthan, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh: real markets, second wave. Rajasthan adds palace hospitality and destination weddings; UP adds scale as corridor cities premiumise.

03 KNOW THE MAP

Dry for spirits: Gujarat, Bihar, Nagaland, Mizoram. (Mizoram's 2025 amendment opened only locally made wine and beer; spirits remain prohibited.)

State-monopoly buying: Kerala and Tamil Nadu purchase through state corporations. A different game, for a later stage.

Everywhere: each state registers your brand, your label and your price separately, on its own calendar and fees, with registrations aligned to the excise year (1 April or 1 July in several states).

04 HOW TO CHOOSE YOUR ONE OR TWO

Four questions decide it: where your budget covers registration plus real launch marketing; where your first channel actually lives; where your importer already holds licences; and where festive-quarter logistics can be met on time.

THE POINT

Your budget decides your map. One or two states, done completely, beats six states done thinly. Your briefing names yours.

Sources: state excise policies; Mizoram Liquor (Prohibition) Amendment Act, 2025; market practice.

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